

Games & Fun Pack • Mission: Quiet Door

Games and Fun

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY

1

hackles up!



Hackle

whose quills stand up when something feels off

2



Latch

LOCK IT

3



Peeper

SPOT IT

4



Pip

SHARE SMART

5



Buddy

SAFE PEOPLE

6



Ember

KIND AND WELL

7



Fixit

FIX IT

PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

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OCTOBER 2026

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[Logo: Hackles]

MISSION: QUIET DOOR

Twelve classroom escape-room-style missions, all defense, all paper, no devices

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep)

What it is: a paper escape room. Teams solve four short puzzle stages. Each stage's answer matches **one labeled envelope**; the right envelope holds the next clue, a wrong one holds a calm "Pause" card. At the end the class whispers the **Door Phrase** and the **Quiet Door** opens. Everybody escapes.

You are the Door Keeper. You read clues aloud (K-2), hand out hints, give stamps, and do any "trickster voice" yourself. Children never play the bad actor.

WHEN	WHAT YOU DO	TIME
Night before	Print the mission pages from the Printables checklist, cut the cards, write the answers on envelopes (the correct label plus 2 to 5 decoy labels per stage), put the next clue inside the correct envelope. A mission takes about 25 to 30 minutes to prepare.	25-30 min
Start (3 min)	Make 4 to 6 teams of 3 to 5. Hand out 3 "Ask Buddy" cards per team. Read the story. Do the Hackles routine.	3 min
Puzzle (22 min Full Escape / 8 min Quick Door)	Teams solve stages at their own pace, one stage at a time, and open the envelope that matches their answer. Walk around. Praise hint requests out loud.	22 min
Door (5 min)	Everyone gathers at the Quiet Door. Teams whisper the Door Phrase . Open the door: "Thank you for being calm." Debrief with the 3 or 4 questions.	5 min

Hints (free and cheerful): Hint 1 = a nudge, Hint 2 = names the skill, Hint 3 = walks through the method (not the answer). After 3 hints, hand over the right envelope ("Teamwork. That is what Fixit is here for.").

Quick Door (10 minutes): run the two stages named in the mission's Time line (about 4 minutes each) plus the Door ritual. If a stage you skip feeds a later one (M1 Stage 3 uses Stage 1's answer; S1 Stage 4 uses Stage 3's key; S2 Stage 4 uses its own count), hand the needed answer over on a "gift card."

If...

- **The room gets loud:** raise a Pause Palm; take a star off the Quiet Meter for the *room*, never a child. Add it back when calm.
- **A team rushes or guesses envelopes:** hand them a "Pause" card and three slow breaths, kindly. Then back to the clue.
- **A child cannot read, spell or write the answer:** pair by choice, point and say the answer, or use the picture-symbol envelopes.

- **A child shares something real:** pause the game, thank them, follow your disclosure box. No promise of secrecy.

Never: shame a team for hints, use a real student's name for a character, or let anyone play the stranger.

Part A: How Mission: Quiet Door works

THE IDEA

At Hackles HQ there is a very special door: the **Quiet Door**. It only opens for a team that is calm. If anybody panics, shouts or rushes, the door stays shut and a little sign flashes: "Pause." Each mission is a locked-room adventure where the class (in teams) solves four puzzle stages in order, then **whispers the Door Phrase** to the Door Keeper (the teacher). The door opens. Everyone does the **Hackles routine** and walks out together.

The twist: speed does not win. Calm wins. A team that rushes gets a free "Pause" from the Door Keeper and has to take three slow breaths before continuing. A team that asks for a hint is **praised**, not penalized (asking for help is the whole point of the kit). **Everybody escapes. No one is out.**

THE 12 MISSIONS

#	BAND	MISSION	THEME	LESSON LINK	SKILL
K1	K-2	Latch's Silly Vault	Password vault	L2 Secret Passwords	Silly, long, secret passwords; who to tell
K2	K-2	Peeper and the Shiny Prize	Fake giveaway	L3 Pause and Ask	Notice "too good", Pause, Tell
K3	K-2	Pretend Picture Detectives	Real or pretend	L8 Real or Pretend?	Pretend pictures; ask a grown-up
E1	3-5	The Passphrase Vault	Password vault	L2 Passphrase Lab	Long random passphrases; never share
E2	3-5	The Case of the Fake Giveaway	Fake giveaway	L3 Scam Spotters	SPOT flags; odd links
E3	3-5	The Too-Friendly Teammate	Group-chat mystery	L6 Game Chat Red Flags; L1 Ladder	Red flags; Help Ladder; Next-Rung Rule
M1	6-8	The Account Vault	Password vault	L2 Account Defense	Reuse, 2-step, recovery, Oops path
M2	6-8	The Rumor in Room 12	Group-chat mystery	L9 Group Chat Dynamics	Evidence, Upstander Four, when to escalate
M3	6-8	The Snow Day That Wasn't	Deepfake detective	L8 / L3	Weak vs strong evidence, source trace, STOP-SAVE-TELL-REPORT
S1	9-12	The Case of the Fake Giveaway	Fake giveaway	L3 Social Engineering	FLAGS, lookalike domains, OAuth permissions, Oops path
S2	9-12	The Credential Vault	Password vault	L2 Credentials and Passkeys	Entropy intuition, reuse blast radius, passkeys, recovery kit
S3	9-12	The Bridge That Wasn't Closing	Deepfake detective	L6 Synthetic Media and Truth	Provenance, lateral reading, responsible sharing

DEFENSE ONLY: THE RULES FOR EVERY MISSION

- 1. Nobody plays the bad actor.** Clues are printed documents. The "trickster voice" belongs to the Door Keeper or to a printed script card.
- 2. No real brands, apps, or people.** Everything uses invented names. Links end in **.example**.
- 3. No scary content.** No graphic detail, no frightening statistics, no sexual content. The 6-8 and 9-12 missions use *non-sexual* synthetic-media scenarios (a fake school announcement, a fake bridge closure). The sensitive lessons (6-8 L7/L8; 9-12 L5/L6/L7) handle other material with their own safeguards.
- 4. Everyone escapes.** No team is "stuck" forever: the Door Keeper has a free hint ladder.
- 5. Pass cards are always available.**

- 6. We teach recognizing, pausing, checking, telling, saving, reporting, recovering.** We never teach how to build a scam, break into an account, or make a fake.

SETUP (USED FOR EVERY MISSION)

Room. Four "stations" (tables or desks with a colored cloth) numbered 1 to 4, plus the **Door Keeper's Desk** and the **Quiet Door** (a classroom door with a paper sign, a decorated cardboard door, or a ribbon across a doorway).

The Answer-Envelope system. Each station holds a stack of **sealed envelopes**. Each envelope is labeled with a possible answer and contains the *next stage's clue*. A team solves a puzzle, finds the envelope that matches their answer, and opens it. **There is only one correct envelope per stage; all other labeled envelopes contain a "Pause" card** that says "Hmm, that is not it. Take three slow breaths, check your work, and try again. Ask Buddy for a hint if you like." This makes every mission **self-checking** (the teacher does not have to check each answer) and **kind** (a wrong answer gives a calm reminder, not a buzzer).

EQUIPMENT	WHAT IT IS
Envelopes	One correct envelope for each stage that has an answer (3 or 4 per mission), plus 2 to 5 "Pause" decoys with different labels for each stage (for example, for a correct "26": decoys "12", "16", "24"). Label with the answer on the front and a symbol (star, moon, sun) so no child has to rely on reading or color. Every correct label is a real answer; there is exactly one correct envelope per stage.
Door Keeper's Desk	Holds the Hint Cards, the stamps or stickers, and the Door Phrase.
"Ask Buddy" cards	Each team gets 3 . A team may turn one in at the Door Keeper's Desk for a hint. Hints are cheerfully given.
The Quiet Meter	A poster with 5 stars. If the room gets too loud, the Door Keeper removes one star. If the room is calm, add one star. At 5 stars the door is "extra open" (a fun reward). Never use as a punishment; use as a calm cue. It measures the room, never a child or a team , and it is switched off for any child who is Deaf or hard of hearing, has Tourette syndrome, or is a loud-by-nature speaker: their voice never costs a star.
Teams	4 to 6 teams of 3 to 5. Every team solves every stage (so every child practices). In 10-minute modes, assign each team a different mission stage.
Pass cards	Green.
Timer	Optional; a quiet "sand timer" or 10-second breath cue works better than a countdown.

HINT LADDER (THE SAME FOR EVERY STAGE)

HINT	WHO GIVES IT	WHAT IT IS
Hint 1	Ask Buddy card (read by Door Keeper)	A nudge: "Look at the second line."
Hint 2	Second Ask Buddy	A bigger nudge that names the skill: "Use SPOT: which letter is hiding?"
Hint 3	Third Ask Buddy	The method walked through (not the answer).
Free Fixit	Door Keeper	If a team is still stuck after three hints, Fixit hands over the envelope with a smile: "Teamwork. That is what Fixit is here for."

10-MINUTE AND 30-MINUTE MODES (FOR EVERY MISSION)

MODE	WHAT TO DO
10-minute "Quick Door"	Every team solves the two stages named in the mission's Time line (about 4 minutes each), then does the Door ritual (2 minutes). If a stage you skip feeds a later one, the Door Keeper hands the needed answer over on a "gift card." Rotation variant for 6 teams: each team solves a different stage and the class puts the answers on the board together; the Door Keeper then gives out the Door Phrase. Or use Stage 1 plus the Door ritual only.
30-minute "Full Escape"	Every team solves all four stages . 3 minutes: story and Hackles routine; 22 minutes: puzzle; 5 minutes: Door Phrase and debrief.

ROLES IN A TEAM (ROTATE EACH STAGE)

- **Reader:** reads the clue aloud (or the teacher reads for K-2).
- **Finder:** finds the envelope and brings it back.
- **Recorder:** writes or draws the answer (no writing in K-2; use stickers).
- **Calm Captain:** keeps the team quiet and calls a Pause (Pause Palm) when voices rise.
- **Hint Holder:** keeps the Ask Buddy cards.

In teams of 3 combine roles. All roles are equally important. In K-2 the teacher is **everyone's** Reader.

THE DOOR RITUAL (THE SAME FOR ALL MISSIONS)

1. The whole class gathers at the Quiet Door and stands in a circle.
2. **Hackles up?** (hand brushes the neck, quiet). **Pause.** (one slow breath, palm up). **Check.** (eyes). **Tell.** (hand on heart, reach out.)
3. The teams each whisper the **Door Phrase** to the Door Keeper (K-2: the class whispers it together). Where a mission says so, each solved stage gave the team one **Door Phrase word card**; otherwise the Door Keeper simply tells the team the phrase when the last stage is done.

Teams that cannot whisper may sign small, or hold up the word cards in order.

4. The Door Keeper opens the door and says: "The Quiet Door is open. Thank you for being calm."
5. **Debrief** (see each mission).

ACCESSIBILITY NOTES

- Print clues in **large type with simple shapes**. For K-2 use pictures. For low vision: large print and high contrast.
- For Deaf and hard-of-hearing students: the Door Keeper uses a visible Pause sign, and all spoken clues are also written. Whispering can be done by **signing small**.
- For students who are anxious about timed tasks: use "no timer" mode. The "Quiet Meter" is the only pacing cue.
- For wheelchair users: arrange stations with 36-inch (about 90 cm) aisles; ensure envelopes are reachable [VERIFY local accessibility guidance].
- Dyslexia-friendly: read all clues aloud; use pictures and colors, with symbols on envelopes (star, moon, sun) as well as words.

Part B: Missions for K-2 (ages 5-7)

General K-2 notes: No reading is required. The teacher reads every clue aloud with a silly voice. Answers are shown by **pointing, placing a card in a hoop, holding up fingers, using a sticker, or doing the hand signal.** Whisper-chant at the Quiet Door.

MISSION K1: LATCH'S SILLY VAULT

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Password vault
LESSON LINK	K-2 L2 Secret Passwords
LEARNING GOAL	Children can say why a password should be long, silly and secret, and name the grown-ups who can know it.
CREW	Latch (mint padlock), Hackle
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 and Stage 4. 30 min: all stages
MATERIALS	8 picture cards (Stage 1), 3 password picture cards (Stage 2), 5 people cards (Stage 3), a "Trusted Hand" poster, a Latch puppet or picture on a stick, a decorated box (the Silly Vault), 5 envelopes

Story (teacher reads).

<i>Field note</i>	No. 1
"Oh no! Latch the friendly padlock is stuck. Latch has forgotten the Silly Words that open the Silly Vault! Inside the vault is the Hackles Key. We need the key to open the Quiet Door and go outside to the playground. Latch says: 'Please help me remember what makes a good password! But shhh, we have to whisper. Passwords are secret!'"	

Stage 1: Secret or Share? (station 1)

Eight picture cards (draw or print simple pictures): **my password, tablet passcode, home address, phone number, favorite color, favorite animal, favorite song, a big hello smile.** Two hoops (or two papers): SECRET (only me and my trusted grown-up) and OK TO SHARE. The team places each card. Teacher reads each card.

Field note

No. 2

Clue to read: "Latch says: some things are secret. Some things are fun to share. Put the cards where they belong. Then count the secret cards and hold up that many fingers."

Answer: 4 secret cards (password, passcode, address, phone number).

Envelope: "4 stars".

Stage 2: Latch's Silly Choice (station 2)

Three picture cards on a table: **Card 1:** a name tag that says "DEV 123" with a sad face. **Card 2:** a purple banana, a trumpet, and a dinosaur in a row with hyphens (purple-banana-dinosaur). **Card 3:** a birthday cake with a number. The teacher reads: "Which one is long, silly, and hard to guess?"

Answer: Card 2 (the three silly words). **Envelope:** green dot (the Latch dot on the back of Card 2).

Stage 3: Who Can Know? (station 3)

Five people cards go on the Trusted Hand poster (or into the HACKLES UP bin): **a grown-up at home** (trusted; draw it as any family: a mum, a dad, two dads, a grandparent, a carer), **teacher** (trusted), **school counselor or librarian** (trusted), **CoolKid99 in game chat** (not trusted), **a pop-up that talks** ("Give me your password for a prize!") (not trusted). The team puts three cards on the fingers and two in the bin.

Answer: 3 trusted grown-ups. **Envelope:** "3 hearts".

Stage 4: Whisper Your Silly Password (station 4)

Each team makes up **three silly practice words** (like "sleepy-pickle-rocket") and whispers them to **Latch** (puppet), who says: "Perfect! Now remember: only tell your trusted grown-up." **Say it out loud before they start: "These are practice words, not your real password. Never whisper a real one to anybody but your trusted grown-up."** The team gets a **Latch sticker**. If a team shouts, Latch says: "Shhh, secret!" and everyone laughs.

Answer: any three silly words, whispered. **Reward:** the Silly Vault (box) opens: inside is the **Hackles Key** (a paper key with a tangerine quill on top).

Door Phrase: whisper together: **"Hackles up. Pause. Check. Tell."**

Hints: Stage 1: "Which of these would be a bad thing to give to a stranger?" Stage 2: "Which one is the silliest?" Stage 3: "Raise your hand if you trust this person to help you."

Debrief (3 minutes): (1) What makes a password strong? (long, silly, secret). (2) Who can know your password? (me and my trusted grown-up). (3) What if someone asks? (Hackles up, Pause, Tell).

Teacher note: In Stage 3 the "CoolKid99" card is the only mention of an online stranger. Do not role-play the stranger. Keep it silly.

MISSION K2: PEEPER AND THE SHINY PRIZE

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	The Case of the Fake Giveaway
LESSON LINK	K-2 L3 Pause and Ask
LEARNING GOAL	Children can spot "too good to be true", "secret", and "hurry" cues; they Pause and Tell.
CREW	Peeper (sky-blue magnifying-glass critter), Hackle, Fixit
TIME	10 min: Stages 1 and 4. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	6 pop-up picture cards, 4 Hackles-move picture cards, a Peeper puppet, a Fixit puppet, a gold gift-box prop with a ribbon (Gifty), stickers, 4 envelopes

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 3
"Peeper has found a SHINY gold box on the playground with a note: 'YOU WON!!! Tap the box! Don't tell anyone!' Peeper's hackles are UP! Peeper says: 'I need detectives to figure out if this is real. The Quiet Door will only open when we have the answer!'"	

Stage 1: Hackles Up or Hackles Down? Six pop-up picture cards (teacher reads each):

1. "WIN A PONY!! TAP NOW!!!" (HACKLES UP)
2. Teacher: "Class story time is at 2." (DOWN)
3. "Don't tell your grown-up. It's our secret prize!" (UP)
4. Grandma's photo of her cat (DOWN)
5. "Free coins! Only 10 seconds left!" (UP)
6. Library: "Your book is ready." (DOWN)

The team sorts into HACKLES UP and HACKLES DOWN. Count the **Hackles Up** cards.

Answer: 3. **Envelope:** "3 fish" (a picture of a fish with a hook).

Stage 2: Put the Moves in Order. Four cards (Hackles Up, Pause Palm, Check Eyes, Tell Wave), each with a symbol on the back: **sun, star, moon, heart**. The team puts the moves in order and turns them over to read the symbols.

Answer: sun, star, moon, heart (Hackles Up = sun, Pause = star, Check = moon, Tell = heart). **Envelope:** "sun star moon heart" (four stickers drawn on the front).

Stage 3: The Tell Wave. Fixit (puppet) says: "Detectives, practice telling! Say: 'I need help. A pop-up said I won.'" Each team says it, with the Tell Wave, to Fixit. The Door Keeper gives a **Tell stamp**.

Answer: the team says the sentence and shows the stamp. **Envelope:** the stamp is the key.

Stage 4: Gifty's Freeze. The Door Keeper holds up the gold box and does a silly voice: "I have a shiny prize for you! Tap me! Tap me!" Teams must do the **Pause Palm** and say "No thanks, Gifty!" three times in a row (three different offers). Gifty says: "Aw, shucks!" and the box opens: inside is the **Hackles Key**.

Door Phrase: "Pause. Check. Tell."

Hints: Stage 1: "Does it say 'hurry' or 'secret'? That is a hackles-up clue." Stage 2: "What do we do first? Notice the feeling." Stage 3: "Put your hand on your heart and reach out."

Debrief: (1) Why were the pop-ups fishy? (they said hurry, secret, free). (2) What did we do? (Pause and tell). (3) How did it feel to say "No thanks"? (proud).

Teacher note: Gifty is a prop, not a person. Do not let a child play Gifty (the Door Keeper does).

MISSION K3: PRETEND PICTURE DETECTIVES

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Real or pretend (the K-2 deepfake detective)
LESSON LINK	K-2 L8 Real or Pretend?; L7 Kind Clicks
LEARNING GOAL	Children know pictures can be pretend (made up), ask "Is it real?" and tell a grown-up if a pretend picture hurts a friend.
CREW	Peeper, Ember, Hackle
TIME	10 min: Stages 1 and 3. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	8 picture cards, one big scene picture (or the described one), 6 kindness cards, a Peeper puppet, stickers, 4 envelopes

Story.

Field note	No. 4
"Peeper loves pictures, but some pictures are REAL and some are PRETEND. Today the Quiet Door has a picture lock. We need Pretend Picture Detectives to find out which are which."	

Stage 1: Real or Pretend? Eight cards: **REAL:** a photo of a cat, a school bus, an apple. **PRETEND:** a dragon, a cow flying over the moon, a talking carrot, a pizza with legs, a castle made of ice cream. The team sorts them. Count PRETEND.

Answer: 5. Envelope: "5 stars".

Stage 2: Silly Spot. A big picture of a classroom (or the teacher describes it): there is a **fish sitting in a chair, snow on the floor, a clock with**

fourteen numbers, a giraffe teaching, a book with wings, shoes on the ceiling. The team points to each silly thing.

Answer: 6. **Envelope:** "6 silly".

Stage 3: Is It Real? Peeper shows a picture of a giant cat taller than a building. It looks very real. The team practices asking: "**Is this real?**" to the Door Keeper, who acts as a grown-up and answers: "Great question! Let's check together." Team shows the **Check Eyes** signal and gets a **Peeper stamp**.

Answer: the team asks "Is this real?" **Reward:** a Peeper stamp.

Stage 4: Kind Pictures. Six cards, teacher reads:

1. Drawing a dragon (OK).
2. Putting a silly hat on a photo of yourself (OK).
3. A picture of a friend with a mean drawing on it (TELL a grown-up).
4. A pretend picture of a pet flying (OK).
5. Sharing a photo of a friend who is crying (TELL a grown-up).
6. A school bus with wings (OK).

The team sorts into OK and TELL. Count TELL.

Answer: 2. **Envelope:** "2 hearts", with the **Hackles Key**.

Door Phrase: "Real or pretend? Ask. Tell."

Debrief: (1) How can we tell if something is real? (ask a grown-up). (2) When do we tell? (when a picture hurts a friend). (3) Ember's rule: pretend pictures are fun when they make friends smile.

Teacher note: Never ask children to produce pretend pictures of classmates. The "TELL" cards describe what to do, not how to do it.

Part C: Missions for Grades 3-5 (ages 8-10)

General 3-5 notes: Students read the clues in teams (the Reader reads aloud). Answers are written on a **Mission Sheet** (one per team: "Stage 1 answer ____, Stage 2 answer ____, ..."). The Calm Captain holds the Pause Palm.

MISSION E1: THE PASSPHRASE VAULT

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Password vault
LESSON LINK	3-5 L2 Passphrase Lab
LEARNING GOAL	Students can tell a strong passphrase (long, random, silly, private) from a weak one, decode a short cipher, build a passphrase, and refuse to share it.
CREW	Latch, Mateo (codebreaker), Hackle
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 3. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	Stage 1 password cards, Stage 2 cipher strip, Word Bank cards, Stage 4 scenario card, 5 envelopes, stamps

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 5
Mateo's grandmother (Abuela) has locked her family photo album with a passphrase, but the note that explains how she picked it got scrambled. The album is in the Passphrase Vault. The Quiet Door will only open if we solve four puzzles. Latch the padlock is nervous: "Remember: a good passphrase is long, silly, and secret."	

Stage 1: Strength Sorter. Six passwords on cards:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 6
P1: Mateo2014	
P2: purple-pancake-rocket-giraffe	
P3: password	
P4: 12345678	

P5: Sunnyday!

P6: stapler-moon-jelly-bicycle

Latch's rule: **Strong = long, made of random words, and not about you.**
Which two cards are strong? Write the card numbers together (smallest first).

Answer: P2 and P6. **Envelope:** "26".

Stage 2: Mateo's Cipher. Mateo hid Abuela's advice with a **shift-by-1 cipher**: every letter was moved one step *forward* in the alphabet (A became B, B became C). To decode, move each letter *back* one step (B becomes A).

Field note

No. 7

Cipher: OFWFS TIBSF JU

Cipher strip (give to the team): A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z. Decode: O to N, F to E, W to V, F to E, S to R.

Answer: NEVER SHARE IT. **Envelope:** "NEVER SHARE IT".

Stage 3: Build a Passphrase. The team gets a **Word Bank** of 24 word cards: **stapler, moon, jelly, bicycle, pancake, rocket, giraffe, purple, window, noodle, trumpet, cactus, pillow, lantern, penguin, marble, spaghetti, turnip, zipper, sailboat, pickle, meteor, cupcake, umbrella.** Rules on **Latch's Checklist**: (1) 4 or more words; (2) no names, birthdays, pets; (3) not a song or a quote; (4) silly is good. The team picks four cards at random (draw them from a bag, do not choose) and writes the phrase, then **whispers it** to the Door Keeper who gives a **Lock stamp** if it passes the checklist. **Say it out loud: this practice phrase is now known to the room, so it is not secret anymore. Never use it for a real account.**

Answer: a four-word passphrase from the bank. **Reward:** Lock stamp; open the envelope marked "LOCK".

Stage 4: Level-Up Offer. Scenario card:

Field note

No. 8

Mateo's friend says in the game chat: "Give me your game password so I can level you up! I'll give it back, promise."

Choose: A) Give it. B) Say: "Nope. If you want to team up, let's play together. My password is only for me and my grown-up." C) Change the password every day.

Answer: B. **Envelope:** "B", containing the **Hackles Key** and a stamp.

Door Phrase: "LONG. SILLY. SECRET." (The correct envelopes of Stages 1, 2 and 3 each hold one Door Phrase word card: LONG, SILLY, SECRET. The Stage 4 envelope holds the Hackles Key and the stamp. The team puts the three words in order and whispers them.)

Hints: Stage 1: "Which cards have real words and are long?" Stage 2: "Say the alphabet in your head: if the code says O, the letter before O is N." Stage 3: "Count your words." Stage 4: "Who is allowed to know my password?"

Debrief: (1) What makes a passphrase strong? (2) Why not use your birthday? (3) What would you say if a friend asks for your password? (4) Who helps you save your passphrases? (a trusted adult or a password manager your family chose).

MISSION E2: THE CASE OF THE FAKE GIVEAWAY

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Fake giveaway
LESSON LINK	3-5 L3 Scam Spotters; L8 Real or Fake?
LEARNING GOAL	Students find SPOT flags (Secret, Pressure, Offer too good to be true, Trick to move you), spot an odd link, order the Hackles routine, and say a Tell sentence.
CREW	Peeper, Priya (the question-asker), Gifty
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 2. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	Giveaway post, 4 link cards, 4 routine cards, a Tell script card, 5 envelopes, Gifty (a gold gift box)

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 9
The Pixel Pals game posted a giveaway! (Pixel Pals is a pretend game.) Priya's classmates are all sharing it. Priya's hackles are up. She says: "Hmm, who made this?" We have to prove whether it's real. The Quiet Door opens when the case is solved.	

Stage 1: SPOT the Post. Read the post:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 10
PIXEL PALS GIVEAWAY!!! You have been chosen to win 10,000 FREE coins! Only 5 minutes left! Click this link and log in to claim: pixelpals-rewards.example. Don't tell your parents, they might ruin the surprise!	

Underline the parts that match SPOT: **S**ecret, **P**ressure, **O**ffer too good, **T**rick to move you. Write the four letters **in the order the clues appear in the post**, from the top.

Answer: OPTS. (O: "10,000 FREE coins"; P: "Only 5 minutes left"; T: "Click this link and log in"; S: "Don't tell your parents".) **Envelope: "OPTS".** (In the first draft the answer was just "SPOT", which a child could guess without reading the post. Ordering the clues makes the puzzle real. Decoys: "SPOT", "POST", "TOPS", "STOP".)

Stage 2: Link Lineup. Four link cards. The **real** game site is **pixelpals.example**.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 11
1. pixelpals.example/help 2. pixe1pals.example/prize 3. pixelpals-FREE-coins.example 4. pixelpals.example/news	

Rule: The real name of the site is the part right before .example. A number that looks like a letter or extra words added to the name is a trick. (Print the link cards in a font where the number 1 and the letter l

look different, and read them out as "pixel-pals" and "pixe-one-pals".) Which two links are fishy? Write them together.

Answer: 2 and 3 (link 2 has a number one instead of "l"; link 3 adds FREE-coins to the name). **Envelope: "23".**

Stage 3: Hackles Order. Four cards, shuffled: **Pause. Hackles up! Tell a trusted adult. Check a different way (not with their link).** Each card has a **letter** on the back. Put the cards in the right order, then flip them to read a word.

Answer: 1 Hackles up! (S) 2 Pause. (A) 3 Check a different way. (F) 4 Tell a trusted adult. (E). The backs spell **SAFE**. **Envelope: "SAFE".** (*The first draft printed 1-2-3-4 on the backs, so the answer "1234" was always the same and guessable. Decoys: "FASE", "FEAS", "AFSE".*)

Stage 4: Priya Tells. Priya wants to tell her teacher about the giveaway post. The team **practices a Tell script** with the Door Keeper (acting as the trusted adult):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 12
"I need help with something online. I found a post that says I won coins, but it says to keep it a secret and to log in. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something."	

The Door Keeper replies with the Good Grown-up Reply: **"Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together."** The team gets a **Tell stamp** and the **Hackles Key**.

Gifty moment (optional, the Door Keeper only): Gifty (the gold box) pops up: "Fine, fine, you're too good for me!"

Door Phrase: "Hackles up. Pause. Check. Tell."

Hints: Stage 1: "The S, P, O, T letters are all hiding. Find each." Stage 2: "Read the real site name slowly. Does anything look odd?" Stage 3: "What do we do first when something feels off?"

Debrief: (1) Which flag did you find first? (2) Why are secrets a flag? (3) What if you already clicked? (Tell. It's never your fault.) (4) Name your trusted adults on your Trusted Hand.

MISSION E3: THE TOO-FRIENDLY TEAMMATE

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	The group-chat mystery
LESSON LINK	3-5 L6 Game Chat Red Flags; L1 Help Ladder; L7 Upstander Moves
LEARNING GOAL	Students find red flags in a game chat, notice facts that do not match, match problems to Ladder rungs (including the Next-Rung Rule), and rehearse a Tell script.
CREW	Kenji (the youngest, quick to tell), Aunt Lin, Buddy
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 3. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	Chat log card, profile clue card, 4 Ladder cards, a Tell script card, 5 envelopes

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 13
Kenji's game chat has a new player called SkyHawk_88. SkyHawk_88 is very friendly... maybe too friendly. Kenji's hackles are up. Kenji wants to find out what's off, and who to tell. The Quiet Door will open when we figure out the mystery. (SkyHawk_88 is a pretend character. We never talk to the people in the mystery.) Teacher: this mission describes a friendly stranger who asks for secrets. If your 3-5 families opted out of Lesson 6 (Game Chat Red Flags), use E2 instead.	

Stage 1: Chat Log Clues. Read the log (print as a chat screen):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 14
SkyHawk_88: Great job Kenji! You're the BEST player in this room. SkyHawk_88: I'm 10 too! I live near you. What school do you go to? SkyHawk_88: Let's go to a private chat. Don't tell anyone, it's more fun. SkyHawk_88: I'll give you 500 free coins if you tell me your password. Kenji: I need to ask my aunt first. SkyHawk_88: Don't! Grown-ups ruin everything.	

Count the **lines that contain a red flag**. (Red flags: asks for private info, moves you to a private chat, wants a secret, offers a gift for a password, tells you not to ask a grown-up.)

Answer: 4 lines (lines 2, 3, 4 and 6). Line 1 is only a compliment; Kenji's line is a good move. **Envelope: "4"**.

Stage 2: Facts That Do Not Match. Profile card says: "**Age: 10. Location: Far away (time zone 9 hours ahead). Joined: today.**" Chat claims: (a) "I'm 10 too!" (b) "I live near you." (c) "I've been playing with you for years." Count the claims that do not match the profile.

Answer: 2 ((b) and (c)). Note: (a) matches the profile but anyone can type an age. **Envelope: "2"**.

(Teacher: this puzzle shows that people online can say anything. We do not figure out who they are. We Pause and Tell.)

Stage 3: Climb the Ladder. Four cards (in order). Match each to the rung:

1. Kenji wants someone to come with him while he tells. (Rung 2: a friend)
2. His friend says "ignore it." (Next-Rung Rule: climb to Rung 3, a trusted adult)
3. Aunt Lin is on the phone and says "later." (Keep climbing: tell another trusted adult or the school counselor)
4. The grown-up helps use the game's report button. (Rung 4: a reporting channel)

Write the **rung numbers in order**.

Answer: 2-3-3-4. **Envelope: "2334"**.

Stage 4: Kenji Tells. The team **rehearses the Tell script** with the Door Keeper acting as Aunt Lin: "I need help with something online. A player asked for my password and said not to tell. I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something." Aunt Lin: "**Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together.**" The team gets a **Tell stamp** and the **Hackles Key**.

Door Phrase: "Block. Report. Tell." (The Door Keeper explains that blocking and reporting are adult-assisted steps; telling is the strongest.)

Hints: Stage 1: "Look for lines that ask for private info or secrets." Stage 2: "Which claims are different from the profile?" Stage 3: "If the first person does not help, what do we do?"

Debrief: (1) What red flag was the most worrying? (2) What happens if a teammate says "don't tell"? (3) Who is on your Trusted Hand? (4) Say the Tell sentence to a partner.

Teacher note: SkyHawk_88 never shares a real name or place; we never role-play the stranger. Keep it light: fun detective voices, no dramatic acting of danger.

Part D: Missions for Grades 6-8 (ages 11-13)

General 6-8 notes: Plain tone, no mascot dialogue (a small Hackle corner icon is fine). Teams of 4 to 5. Each stage clue is printed on a card. Quiet Meter works as a calm cue. Hint ladder is available.

MISSION MI: THE ACCOUNT VAULT

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Password vault
LESSON LINK	6-8 L2 Account Defense
LEARNING GOAL	Students spot password reuse, rank recovery methods, decode a cipher, and put the Oops path in order.
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 3. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	Account grid, 4 ranking cards, cipher text and strip, 5 Oops cards, 5 envelopes

Story.

Field note	No. 15
A student's accounts have been locked by a prank "vault." The prankster left four riddles, and a note: "Solve them to unlock your accounts." (The prankster is pretend. The riddles are really lessons in account defense.) The Quiet Door will open when you have the Door Phrase.	

Stage 1: The Reuse Grid.

ACCOUNT	PASSWORD
Game	blue!Tiger7
Email	blue!Tiger7
Music	Pancake\$Moon4
Shop	blue!Tiger7
School portal	Quokka-Lantern-91
Social	Pancake\$Moon4

If the Game site is breached and the attacker gets "blue!Tiger7", how many accounts use that same password, counting the Game account

itself? Answer with that number. (This number is also your **cipher shift** for Stage 3.)

Answer: 3 (Game, Email, Shop). **Envelope:** "3".

Stage 2: Rank the Recovery Methods. Four cards (digit on the back). Put them in order from **strongest protection** to **weakest**:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 16
Card K: Passkey or security key Card A: Authenticator app code Card T: Text message code Card N: Password only (no second step)	

The digits on the backs read left to right when the order is correct.

Answer: K (back 7), A (back 1), T (back 4), N (back 9): **7149**. [VERIFY ranking nuance with Lesson 2; app codes and text codes can still be phished in real time; passkeys and security keys are bound to the real site.] **Envelope:** "7149".

Stage 3: Shift Cipher. Use your Stage 1 answer as the shift. Move each letter **back** that many steps in the alphabet to decode:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 17
RQH SDVVZRUG SHU DFFRXQW	

Answer: ONE PASSWORD PER ACCOUNT (shift 3). **Envelope:** "ONE PASSWORD PER ACCOUNT".

Stage 4: The Oops Path. An account was taken over after a click. Put the five Oops cards in the best order (each card has a **letter** on the back; shuffle the cards before you give them out):

- 1. Pause: breathe. It is not your fault.** (back: F)
- 2. Tell a trusted adult.** (back: I)
- 3. Change the password (and any account that shares it).** (back: X)
- 4. Turn on 2-step verification.** (back: I)
- 5. Watch for odd messages or sign-ins; sign out other devices.** (back: T)

Answer: 1-2-3-4-5 [VERIFY with the L2 Oops plan wording]. The backs read **FIXIT**. **Envelope: "FIXIT"**. (*The first draft used the label "12345", which is guessable without solving; letters on the backs make the order self-checking.*)

Door Phrase: "One password per account." (Whisper it with the Hackles signals.)

Hints: Stage 1: "Look for two accounts with the same password." Stage 2: "Which method can't be tricked by a fake site?" Stage 3: "A to D with shift 3: D to A." Stage 4: "What do you do first when you feel panic?"

Debrief: (1) Which account would be the worst to have taken over? (Email: it resets the others.) (2) What is one thing you will change tonight? (3) Who would you tell? (4) What's the Oops path?

MISSION M2: THE RUMOR IN ROOM 12

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	The group-chat mystery
LESSON LINK	6-8 L9 Group Chat Dynamics; L1 Help Ladder; L7 (Upstander Four)
LEARNING GOAL	Students sort messages by time, learn what evidence to SAVE and what to skip, match Upstander moves, and decide when to escalate.
TIME	10 min: Stages 1 + 2. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	5 message cards, 8 action cards, 4 Upstander cards, 6 escalation cards, 5 envelopes

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 18
A rumor spread in a class group chat last night. Nobody is sure where it began. The group wants to trace the conversation and decide what to do, <i>without blaming anyone</i> . (All names are pretend.) The Quiet Door only opens when the case is solved with kindness.	

Stage 1: Message Timeline. Five message cards (shuffled):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 19
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Hana, 7:43 p.m.: wait is that true??

Cam, 7:41 p.m.: heard Remy cheated on the science test

Sky, 7:48 p.m.: someone should tell Mr. Lee

Ari, 7:44 p.m.: omg everyone knows now

Tomas, 7:46 p.m.: lol who told you

Put the messages in time order. Read the **first letter of each name** in order.

Answer: CHATS (Cam, Hana, Ari, Tomas, Sky). **Envelope:** "CHATS".

Note: Cam said "heard," so the rumor came from somewhere else. The first sender is not necessarily the source, and is not "guilty."

Stage 2: SAVE or Skip? Eight action cards. Choose the ones that help:

1. Take screenshots that show names and times. (DO)
2. Reply "lol." (SKIP)
3. Forward it to another group. (SKIP)
4. Delete the whole chat so nobody sees it. (SKIP: keep evidence)
5. Tell a trusted adult. (DO)
6. Report the messages in the app. (DO)
7. Message Remy privately: "That's not okay. Are you okay? I'm here." (DO)
8. Post "it's all fake!!!" in angry capitals. (SKIP)

Count the DO cards.

Answer: 4. **Envelope:** "4".

Stage 3: The Upstander Four. Match each line to a move: **Say It, Stand With, Keep It (don't pass it on), Tell It.**

Field note

No. 20

L1: "Mr. Lee, can I show you something about a chat?"

L2: "That's not cool. Please stop."

L3: "Hey Remy, are you okay? I'm here."

L4: (Not forwarding the rumor to anyone.)

Write the first letters of the move names in order L1 to L4.

Answer: T-S-W-K (Tell It, Say It, Stand With, Keep It). **Envelope:** "TSWK". (The lines are shuffled on purpose: in the first draft they came in the same order as the Upstander Four, so "SWKT" could be guessed. Decoys: "SWKT", "KWST", "WSTK".)

Stage 4: Handle or Escalate? Six cards. Which need an adult **right now**?

No. 21
<i>Field note</i> (a) "Everyone meet behind the gym after school to fight Remy." (b) "ugh he's so annoying." (c) A message that suggests someone is thinking about hurting themselves or others. (d) "Stop sending that, it's mean." (e) Someone posts Remy's home address in the chat. (f) A joke about the science test.

Answer: 3 (a, c, e). **Envelope:** "3". (Note for the Door Keeper: for any message that suggests risk to someone's safety, follow your school's protocol; the national 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline is available in the U.S. [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: hotline details checked on the organization's own site]. Do not leave a student alone.) **Names:** if a student in your class is named Remy, Cam, Hana, Ari, Tomas or Sky, change the character names so nobody feels pointed at.

Door Phrase: "Save. Speak. Tell."

Hints: Stage 1: "Look at the timestamps." Stage 2: "Which cards keep evidence and help Remy?" Stage 3: "Which move is about the person and which is about the chat?" Stage 4: "Which messages involve safety, privacy or threats?"

Debrief: (1) Does the first sender equal the source? (2) Which Upstander move feels easiest? Hardest? (3) What would you save? (4) When is it not "tattling"? (5) Who would you tell? Practice the Tell-3 sentence.

MISSION M3: THE SNOW DAY THAT WASN'T

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	The deepfake detective (non-sexual)
LESSON LINK	6-8 L8 Fakes That Hurt (the <i>non-sexual</i> thread); L3 Phish Lab
LEARNING GOAL	Students understand that glitch-spotting is weak evidence , that source checks are stronger , how to verify using a second channel, and the response STOP · SAVE · TELL · REPORT.
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 3. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	6 evidence cards, source table, A1Z26 cipher card, 8 response cards, 5 envelopes

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 22
It's Sunday night. A voice message that sounds just like the principal says: "School is closed tomorrow because of snow." A photo shows the school buried in snow. The messages are all over the class chats. But the weather forecast says clear skies. Which is real? (The people and the school are pretend.) The Quiet Door only opens when you can prove it.	

Stage 1: Weak or Strong Evidence? Six statements. Which are **strong** evidence? Count them.

TO VERIFY
1. The voice sounds exactly like the principal. (WEAK: voices can be copied [VERIFY]) 2. The photo has no weird hands or text. (WEAK: fakes keep improving) 3. It has been shared 5,000 times. (WEAK) 4. The school district's website and official app say school is open. (STRONG) 5. The account that posted it was made yesterday and has no other posts. (STRONG ENOUGH TO COUNT: a brand-new empty account is a serious warning sign, though not proof by itself) 6. No news station or weather service mentions a storm. (STRONG)

Answer: 3. Envelope: "3".

Stage 2: Trace the Source. A table of posts:

POSTER	TIME	ACCOUNT AGE	SAYS
m_ortiz	6:19 a.m.	4 years	"Sharing from @snowwatch_news"
snowwatch_news	6:02 a.m.	1 day	"SCHOOL CLOSED! Voice memo attached."
riley.k	6:31 a.m.	3 years	"Is this true?"
jo_the_goat	6:40 a.m.	2 years	"Someone confirm?"
school_district_official	6:52 a.m.	8 years	"School is OPEN today. Please ignore false reports."

Which post came **first**? Write its time without the colon.

Answer: 602 (snowwatch_news, a one-day-old account). **Envelope: "602".**

Stage 3: A1Z26 Cipher. A = 1, B = 2 ... Z = 26. Decode:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 23
3 8 5 3 11 / 20 8 5 / 19 15 21 18 3 5	

Answer: CHECK THE SOURCE. Envelope: "CHECK THE SOURCE".

Stage 4: What Do You Do? A *different* fake (a voice clip of a real classmate saying something mean) starts going around. Eight response cards. Pick the four **best** moves:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 24
DO: Do not forward it. · SAVE the words and links (not the clip itself). · TELL a trusted adult. · REPORT it in the app. DON'T: Forward it "so people know it's fake." · Confront the poster in the chat. · Delete everything. · Post a mean reply.	

Put the four DO cards in order: **STOP (don't forward), SAVE, TELL, REPORT.**

Answer: S-S-T-R. Envelope: "SSTR".

Door Phrase: "Check the source."

Hints: Stage 1: "Which clues are about how real it looks, and which are about where it came from?" Stage 2: "Compare the times and the account

ages." Stage 3: "A=1, so 3 is C." Stage 4: "What is the first thing you do? Do nothing yet. That's the Pause."

Debrief: (1) Why is "it sounds real" weak evidence? (2) What is a second channel you could use? (3) What do you do when a fake targets a classmate? (4) Where do you report?

Teacher note: Do not show or create any real synthetic media in class. If a student brings up fake sexual images, say "we handle that in a different lesson, with supports" and refer to the counselor per your guide.

Part E: Missions for Grades 9-12 (ages 14-18)

General 9-12 notes: Plain, respectful, no mascot dialogue. Teams of 4. The puzzles are slightly harder; hints are free. Debriefs link to lesson content and to personal defense plans.

MISSION S1: THE CASE OF THE FAKE GIVEAWAY

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Fake giveaway (social engineering)
LESSON LINK	9-12 L3 Social Engineering Case Lab
LEARNING GOAL	Students apply FLAGS to a DM, recognize lookalike domains, evaluate an over-broad permissions screen, order the Oops path, and decode a Vigenère cipher.
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 2. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	DM card, URL cards, consent-screen card, Oops cards, cipher card with tabula recta (or a key strip), 5 envelopes

Story.

Field note	No. 25
A "streamer" account DMs hundreds of students: "You're one of our supporters. Claim your prize." You've been asked to analyze it for the student council's safety newsletter. The Quiet Door opens when your analysis is complete. (Names are pretend.)	

Stage 1: FLAGS. Read the DM:

TO VERIFY
From: StreamSquad_Official: Hey! You were picked for our \$500 supporter giveaway! Verify your account at supporter-verify.example/claim to get your prize. 30 minutes left!

FLAGS = **F**ast, **L**ogin ask, **A**marzing offer, **G**otta keep it secret, **S**trange sender or link. **Which FLAGS letter is missing?**

Answer: G (there is no secrecy ask). **Envelope: "G".**

Stage 2: Lookalike Domains. The real site is **streamsquad.example**. Six links:

TO VERIFY

1. supporter-verify.example/claim
2. streamsquad.example/help
3. streamsquad.example.verify-now.example/login
4. streamsqaud.example/claim
5. streamsquad.example/news
6. streamsquad-support.example/login

For this puzzle, only links on **exactly** streamsquad.example are official. How many links are **lookalikes**?

Answer: 4 (1, 3, 4, 6). **Envelope:** "4".

Debrief point: You cannot always tell by looking at a link, so **go to the official site yourself** instead of using the message's link.

Stage 3: The Consent Screen. The link opens a "Sign in with" screen asking for:

Field note

No. 26

- ☐ See your public profile
- ☐ See your email address
- ☐ Read your private messages
- ☐ Send messages as you
- ☐ See and manage your friends list
- ☐ Post on your behalf
- ☐ Stay signed in forever (offline access)

A giveaway needs, at most, your public profile. How many of the permissions are **clearly excessive** (not needed for a giveaway, and risky)?

Answer: 5 (private messages, send as you, manage friends, post on your behalf, offline access). The email address is borderline. **Envelope:** "5", which contains the **cipher key: PAUSE** and the cipher text.

Stage 4: Oops, Then Decode. (a) The team puts six Oops cards in order (each card has a **letter** on the back; shuffle the cards first): *Tell a trusted adult and report the message (S); Revoke the app's permissions and sign out other sessions (E); Change the password on the real site (C); Turn on 2-step or passkeys (U); Warn friends if messages were sent as you (R); Watch for new sign-in alerts (E).* The backs read **SECURE** when the order is right, so the team can check itself. (b) The team then decodes a **Vigenère cipher** with key **PAUSE**. (Each letter of the key tells how many steps to shift each plaintext letter *back*: P = 15, A = 0, U = 20, S = 18, E = 4. Repeat the key across letters and skip spaces and the key continues.)

Field note

No. 27

KELAJN OH S WTCIFH RHUFRTL

Answer: VERIFY ON A SECOND CHANNEL. **Door Phrase.**

Oops order (the answer): tell and report; revoke permissions and sign out; change the password on the real site; turn on 2-step or passkeys; warn friends; watch alerts. The envelope labeled "**SECURE**" holds the final Door Phrase card. [VERIFY with the L2/L3 Oops path wording: this order puts Tell first, as the kit's Oops path does. Other orders are defensible in real life, so the Door Keeper explains that this puzzle uses the kit's order. The first draft left the order open, so the answer was not unique.]

Door Phrase: "Verify on a second channel."

Hints: Stage 1: "Write out F, L, A, G, S and check each against the message." Stage 2: "Compare every character." Stage 3: "What data does a giveaway need?" Stage 4: "Key letter P: shift back 15, so K becomes V."

Debrief: (1) Which FLAGS were the loudest? (2) Why does "who gains if I act now" matter? (3) What is the second channel for this DM? (4) What is your Oops path? (5) Which permission would you refuse?

MISSION S2: THE CREDENTIAL VAULT

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	Password vault
LESSON LINK	9-12 L2 Credentials and Passkeys
LEARNING GOAL	Students develop intuition about password strength, understand reuse blast radius, rank sign-in methods, and assemble a recovery kit.
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 2. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	Combination cards, account grid, 4 sign-in cards, 8 recovery-kit cards, Vigenère cipher card, 5 envelopes

Story.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 28
Your cyber-club is locked out of the club's shared vault. The previous treasurer left four puzzles. Solving them reveals how the vault was protected and how to set it up better. The Quiet Door opens at the end. (Pretend scenario.)	

Stage 1: Combinations. Rank these from **most** possible combinations to **fewest** (assuming truly random choices):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 29
A: 8 random characters from 94 symbols: about 6.1×10 to the 15th power B: 4 random words from a 2,000-word list: 1.6×10 to the 13th power C: 5 random words from a 2,000-word list: 3.2×10 to the 16th power D: 6 random words from a 7,776-word list: about 2.2×10 to the 23rd power E: "P@ssw0rd!" (a common password with swaps): effectively a guess in the first few attempts	

Answer: D, C, A, B, E (write as DCABE). [VERIFY the math; also note that people rarely choose truly randomly, so the numbers are best-case; length and randomness are what matter.] **Envelope: "DCABE".**

Stage 2: Reuse Blast Radius. Five accounts and their passwords (A, B, C are three different passwords):

ACCOUNT	PASSWORD
Email	A
Shop	A
Social	A
Game	B
School portal	C

The Shop site is breached and password **A** is stolen. Name the one account whose takeover would let someone **reset the other accounts**, and is also exposed here.

Answer: EMAIL. **Envelope:** "EMAIL".

Stage 3: Sign-In Ladder. Rank from most to least resistant to phishing. The backs of the cards give a four-digit code:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 30
Passkey or hardware security key (back: 3) Authenticator app code (back: 1) Text message code (back: 5) Password only (back: 7)	

Answer: 3157. [VERIFY: passkeys and security keys are generally the most phishing-resistant; app and text codes can still be phished in real time; a text code is better than nothing.] **Envelope:** "3157".

Stage 4: The Recovery Kit. Eight cards: which belong in a good **Recovery Kit**? Pick them, count them, then decode the cipher with the key given in the envelope.

<i>Field note</i>	No. 31
IN: Backup codes saved offline in a safe place · A second trusted device or recovery contact · A written list of which accounts use which email (no passwords) · Password-manager emergency access · An up-to-date recovery phone number or email OUT: Passwords on a sticky note on the monitor · A screenshot of backup codes in the photo gallery · Giving a friend your codes "for safekeeping"	

Answer: 5 items IN. The envelope "5" contains **key: TELL** and the cipher text:

<i>Field note</i>	No. 32
IEDDDIJ MXEED IEDDPSCO	

Decode with Vigenère key TELL (T = 19, E = 4, L = 11, L = 11; shift back; the key repeats and skips spaces): **PASKEY BEATS PASSWORD**
[VERIFY: "usually, against phishing"].

Door Phrase: "Passkey beats password." (Teacher adds: usually, and only if you set up recovery.)

Hints: Stage 1: "More words beat more symbols if the list is large. Compare exponents." Stage 2: "Which account sends reset links?" Stage 3: "Which method is tied to the real site?" Stage 4: "Would a thief benefit from this item?"

Debrief: (1) What is the cheapest step that makes you safer? (2) Which account is your "keys to the kingdom"? (3) What would your recovery kit hold? (4) Who is your person to tell?

MISSION S3: THE BRIDGE THAT WASN'T CLOSING

SPECIMEN LABEL	
THEME	The deepfake detective
LESSON LINK	9-12 L6 Synthetic Media and Truth
LEARNING GOAL	Students separate weak evidence (looks real) from stronger evidence (source, corroboration, provenance), trace a post to its origin, choose responsible sharing behavior, and decode a cipher.
TIME	10 min: Stage 1 + Stage 2. 30 min: all
MATERIALS	8 evidence cards, source table, 8 action cards, Atbash cipher card, 5 envelopes

Story.

Field note	No. 33
A video circulates of the (pretend) mayor of Maplewood announcing, "The Maple Bridge closes tomorrow for 3 months." Commuters are panicking. The mayor's office says nothing. You are the school media club, deciding what to do before you share anything. The Quiet Door opens when the club has a plan. (All names are pretend.)	

Stage 1: Evidence Strength. Eight statements. Which are **strong** evidence? Count them.

Field note	No. 34
1. The audio sounds perfectly like the mayor. (weak) 2. His mouth movements match the words. (weak) 3. It has been shared thousands of times. (weak) 4. The video is high resolution. (weak) 5. The town's official website and channel say nothing about a closure. (STRONG) 6. No local news outlet reports it. (STRONG) 7. The first uploader is an account created two days ago with no history. (STRONG) 8. Provenance data (such as content credentials) is missing or shows the video was generated or edited [VERIFY the	

state of provenance standards such as C2PA in your region].
(STRONG, with caveat)

Answer: 4. Envelope: "4".

Stage 2: Lateral Reading. A table of sources:

SOURCE	FIRST TIME	ACCOUNT
bridgeupdate4	21:07	Created 2 days ago
maplewood_gazette	22:15	Local paper, 20 years: "We are investigating"
town_of_maplewood	22:40	Official: "No closure is planned."
commuter_carl	21:55	Personal: "Is this real?"
news_now_xyz	21:30	New site: "Mayor announces..." (copy)

Who posted first? Write the time without the colon.

Answer: 2107. Envelope: "2107".

Stage 3: What Do You Do? Eight cards. Choose the **responsible** ones and count them.

TO VERIFY

DO: Check the official channel · Report the video on the platform · Save the link and timestamp · Share the official correction (after verifying) · Tell a trusted adult or teacher

DON'T: Forward "just in case" · Quote-share it with outrage · Dunk on the person who shared it

Answer: 5 DO cards. Envelope: "5".

Stage 4: Mirror Cipher. The last envelope contains an **Atbash** cipher (A = Z, B = Y, C = X ... Z = A):

<i>Field note</i>	No. 35
GIFHG GSV HLFIXV MLG GSV KRCVOH	

Answer: TRUST THE SOURCE NOT THE PIXELS.

Door Phrase: "Trust the source, not the pixels." (Teacher: today's pixels are easy to fake; sources and corroboration are what we can check [VERIFY].)

Hints: Stage 1: "Which clues are about how real it looks?" Stage 2: "Find the earliest time." Stage 3: "Which actions slow the spread and help truth?" Stage 4: "A is Z, so G is T."

Debrief: (1) Why is "looks real" no longer enough? (2) What would you check first? (3) What is the harm in forwarding "just in case"? (4) What is the first thing a newsroom does with a viral clip?

Teacher note: No synthetic sexual content appears in this mission. If students raise it, refer to Lesson 5 and 6 supports and the counselor.

Part F: Teacher Answer Keys (print for the Door Keeper only; do not put in student sets)

K-2 (DOOR KEEPER'S CHEAT SHEET)

MISSION	STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	DOOR PHRASE
K1 Latch's Silly Vault	4 secret cards (password, passcode, address, phone number)	Card 2: purple-banana-dinosaur	3 trusted (grown-up at home, teacher, counselor or librarian)	Whisper 3 practice words to Latch	Hackles up. Pause. Check. Tell.
K2 Peeper and the Shiny Prize	3 Hackles Up cards (1, 3, 5)	sun, star, moon, heart	Tell sentence + Tell stamp	Pause Palm to Gifty 3 times	Pause. Check. Tell.
K3 Pretend Picture Detectives	5 pretend	6 silly things	Ask "Is this real?"	2 TELL cards	Real or pretend? Ask. Tell.

3-5

MISSION	STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	DOOR PHRASE
E1 Passphrase Vault	P2 and P6 (envelope 26)	NEVER SHARE IT	Passphrase from the bank (4 words, passes the checklist)	B	LONG. SILLY. SECRET.
E2 Fake Giveaway	OPTS (SPOT letters in the order they appear)	links 2 and 3 (envelope 23)	1 Hackles up, 2 Pause, 3 Check, 4 Tell (backs spell SAFE)	Tell script, Good Grown-up Reply, stamp	Hackles up. Pause. Check. Tell.
E3 Too-Friendly Teammate	4 flagged lines	2 claims mismatch	2-3-3-4	Tell script	Block. Report. Tell.

6-8

MISSION	STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	DOOR PHRASE
M1 Account Vault	3	7149 (K, A, T, N)	ONE PASSWORD PER ACCOUNT (shift 3)	Oops path in order 1-2-3-4-5 (backs spell FIXIT)	One password per account
M2 Rumor in Room 12	CHATS	4 DO cards	TSWK	3 escalations (a, c, e)	Save. Speak. Tell.
M3 Snow Day	3 strong clues (4, 5, 6)	602	CHECK THE SOURCE	SSTR	Check the source

9-12

MISSION	STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	DOOR PHRASE
S1 Fake Giveaway	G missing	4 lookalikes (1, 3, 4, 6)	5 excessive permissions (key PAUSE)	Oops order (backs spell SECURE), then VERIFY ON A SECOND CHANNEL	Verify on a second channel
S2 Credential Vault	DCABE	EMAIL	3157	5 items IN (key TELL), PASSKEY BEATS PASSWORD	Passkey beats password
S3 Bridge	4 strong (5, 6, 7, 8)	2107	5 DO	TRUST THE SOURCE NOT THE PIXELS (Atbash)	Trust the source, not the pixels

CIPHER QUICK REFERENCE (DOOR KEEPER)

CIPHER	TEXT	PLAINTEXT	METHOD
E1 shift-1	OFWFS TIBSF JU	NEVER SHARE IT	back 1
M1 shift-3	RQH SDVVZRUG SHU DFFRXQW	ONE PASSWORD PER ACCOUNT	back 3
M3 A1Z26	3 8 5 3 1 1 / 20 8 5 / 19 15 21 18 3 5	CHECK THE SOURCE	A=1
S1 Vigenère key PAUSE	KELAJN OH S WTCIFH RHUFRTL	VERIFY ON A SECOND CHANNEL	key repeats over letters only
S2 Vigenère key TELL	IEDDDIJ MXEED IEDDPSCO	PASSKEY BEATS PASSWORD	key repeats over letters only
S3 Atbash	GIFHG GSV HLFIXV MLG GSV KRCVOH	TRUST THE SOURCE NOT THE PIXELS	A=Z, B=Y ...

ENVELOPE LABELS CHECKLIST (PER MISSION)

- Label each correct envelope with the answer exactly as above (and a star, moon or sun symbol).
- Make at least 2 decoy envelopes per stage. Decoys contain the **Pause card**: "Hmm, not quite. Take three slow breaths. Check your work. Ask Buddy for a hint if you like."
- Put the next stage's clue inside the correct envelope. The last envelope holds the Door Phrase, a stamp, and the **Hackles Key** (a paper key with a tangerine quill on top).

Part G: Make your own mission (defense-only template)

1. **Pick one skill** from a lesson (for example, "check a link").

2. **Write 4 puzzles** that each practice one piece of the skill: **Notice** (find the flag), **Check** (verify a second way), **Tell** (practice the sentence), **Fix** (recover).
3. **Give each puzzle a checkable answer** (a number, word or order).
4. **Tie the answers to the Door Phrase** (cipher, assembled phrase, or the Hackles routine).
5. **Remove anything that teaches how to cause harm.** Ask: "Would a child learn how to trick someone?" If yes, rewrite it.
6. **Test with two students** before the class.

Part H: Accessibility variants (all missions)

NEED	WHAT TO DO
Color-vision difference	Never use envelope color as the clue. Every envelope has a word or number label and a symbol (star, moon, sun, heart, fish). Quiet Meter stars are counted, not colored.
Low vision / blind	Large print (at least 24 pt); high-contrast black on white or yellow; read every clue aloud; put a raised dot or sticker on the correct envelope after the team solves, never before. Provide cipher strips in large print.
Deaf or hard of hearing	Every clue is printed as well as spoken. Whisper at the door = sign small or hold up the word cards. Hints are written on the Ask Buddy cards. The Door Keeper's Pause sign is a visible card.
Dyslexia / reading difficulty	Pair by choice; read aloud; use pictures and symbols; print link cards in a font that distinguishes l, I and i. Allow answers by pointing to the matching envelope symbol.
English language learners	Read each clue aloud; allow a team to discuss in any language; keep a picture glossary (lock, shell, ladder, door). Cipher stages assume the English alphabet: for students new to it, the Door Keeper hands over the decoded phrase as soon as the team has shown the method on two letters.
Motor / mobility	36-inch (about 90 cm) aisles; envelopes at table height; a "Finder" role can be done by a classmate; no stage needs running.
Sensory / anxiety	"No timer" mode. Quiet Meter is room-only. A quiet corner with a Pass card. The Pause card for a wrong envelope is calm, never a buzzer.
Cognitive / K-2 differences	Stage I plus the Door ritual only. Use pictures; the teacher is everyone's Reader.

Part I: Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this)

Art comes from the art team. Reference these files in [kit/09_Art/characters/](#) (do not edit them). Gifty is a prop in the Door Keeper's hand; **[ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in [characters/](#); ask the art team for [gifty.png](#)].**

For every mission (once): 1 Door sign ("Quiet Door", [hackle_curious.png](#)), 1 Quiet Meter poster (5 stars), 3 "Ask Buddy" cards per team x 6 teams = **18 cards** ([buddy.png](#)), 1 "Pause" decoy card per decoy envelope ([fixit.png](#); 12 to 20 copies), 1 Hackles Key per mission (paper key, [hackle_proud.png](#)), 1 stamp or sticker per child, green Pass cards for every child (word PASS + check mark), the Teacher Quick Start page, and the Part F answer key (Door Keeper only).

MISSION	PRINT AND CUT	ENVELOPES (CORRECT LABEL; ADD 2 TO 5 DECOYS PER STAGE)	ART
KI Latch's Silly Vault	8 picture cards (Stage I) + 2 hoop signs; 3 password picture cards; 5 people cards + Trusted Hand poster + HACKLES UP bin sign; Latch puppet or picture; decorated box	"4 stars"; green dot on Card 2; "3 hearts" (3 correct)	latch.png , hackle_curious.png

MISSION	PRINT AND CUT	ENVELOPES (CORRECT LABEL; ADD 2 TO 5 DECOYS PER STAGE)	ART
K2 Peeper and the Shiny Prize	6 pop-up picture cards; 4 Hackles-move cards (sun, star, moon, heart on backs); Tell stamp	"3 fish"; "sun star moon heart" (2 correct)	peeper.png, fixit.png, hackle_up.png
K3 Pretend Picture Detectives	8 picture cards; 1 big classroom scene; 6 kindness cards; Peeper stamp	"5 stars"; "6 silly"; "2 hearts" (3 correct)	peeper.png, kindle.png
E1 The Passphrase Vault	6 password cards (P1-P6); alphabet strip; cipher strip; 24 word cards ; a bag; Latch's Checklist poster; Stage 4 scenario card (A/B/C); 3 Door Phrase word cards (LONG, SILLY, SECRET); Mission Sheet per team	"26"; "NEVER SHARE IT"; "LOCK"; "B" (4 correct)	latch.png, hackle_happy.png
E2 The Case of the Fake Giveaway	giveaway post card; 4 link cards (large type); 4 routine cards (letters S, A, F, E on backs); Tell script card; Mission Sheet	"OPTS"; "23"; "SAFE" (3 correct)	peeper.png, hackle_up.png
E3 The Too-Friendly Teammate	chat log card; profile card; 4 Ladder cards; Tell script card; Mission Sheet	"4"; "2"; "2334" (3 correct)	buddy.png, hackle_curious.png
M1 The Account Vault	reuse grid card; 4 ranking cards (backs 7, 1, 4, 9); cipher text card + alphabet strip; 5 Oops cards (backs F, I, X, I, T)	"3"; "7149"; "ONE PASSWORD PER ACCOUNT"; "FIXIT" (4 correct)	corner icon hackle_curious.png only
M2 The Rumor in Room 12	5 message cards; 8 action cards; 4 Upstander lines (L1-L4); 6 escalation cards	"CHATS"; "4"; "TSWK"; "3" (4 correct)	corner icon only
M3 The Snow Day That Wasn't	6 evidence cards; source table; A1Z26 card; 8 response cards (4 DO, 4 DON'T)	"3"; "602"; "CHECK THE SOURCE"; "SSTR" (4 correct)	corner icon only
S1 The Case of the Fake Giveaway	DM card; 6 URL cards; consent-screen card; 6 Oops cards (backs S, E, C, U, R, E); cipher card with a PAUSE key strip and a tabula recta	"G"; "4"; "5"; "SECURE" (4 correct)	kit/09_Art/icon_spot_it.png
S2 The Credential Vault	5 combination cards; account grid; 4 sign-in cards (backs 3, 1, 5, 7); 8 recovery-kit cards; cipher card (key TELL)	"DCABE"; "EMAIL"; "3157"; "5" (4 correct)	kit/09_Art/icon_lock_it.png
S3 The Bridge That Wasn't Closing	8 evidence cards; source table; 8 action cards (5 DO, 3 DON'T); Atbash cipher card	"4"; "2107"; "5" (3 correct); the Atbash plaintext is the last clue	kit/09_Art/icon_spot_it.png

Verification note (script-checked): all six ciphers (E1 shift-1, M1 shift-3, M3 A1Z26, S1 Vigenere PAUSE, S2 Vigenere TELL, S3 Atbash) decode to the stated phrases; the S2 combination numbers (94^8 , 2000^4 , 2000^5 , 7776^6) are correct; every puzzle in this file has exactly one correct envelope.